



Rashtriya Janata Dal

The **Rashtriya Janata Dal** (abbreviated as **RJD**; translation: **National People's Party**) is an Indian political party, mainly based in the state of Bihar. The party was founded in 1997 by Lalu Prasad Yadav.^{[5][6]}

The party's support base has traditionally been Other Backward Classes, Dalits and Muslims and it is considered a political champion of the lower castes.^[7] In 2008, RJD received the status of recognized national level party following its performance in north-eastern states.^[8] RJD was derecognised as a national party on 30 July 2010.^[9] Leading the Mahagathbandhan alliance with 105 MLAs, it is currently the official opposition in Bihar. RJD is part of Ruling Government in Jharkhand and Kerala with its allies in Mahagathbandhan (Jharkhand) and LDF respectively.^[10]

History

Formation

There was pressure on Lalu Prasad Yadav to resign from Chief minister post within and outside of Janata Dal following being chargesheeted in the Fodder scam. On 5 July 1997, Pappu Yadav, Raghuvansh Prasad Singh, Mohammad Shahabuddin, Abdul Bari Siddiqui, Kanti Singh, Mohammed Taslimuddin and Md Ali Ashraf Fatmi along with seventeen Lok Sabha MPs and eight Rajya Sabha MPs along with supporters gathered at New Delhi formed the new political party, *Rashtriya Janata Dal*. It was formed as breakaway of Janata Dal. Lalu Prasad was elected as the first president of RJD. It is a centre-left party.^[11]

With demands for his resignation continuing to mount, on 25 July, Lalu resigned from his position, but was able to install his wife, Rabri Devi as the new chief minister on the same day.

In the March 1998 national elections, RJD won 17 Lok Sabha seats from Bihar but failed to make significant headway in any other state. Later that year, the party formed an alliance with Mulayam Singh Yadav's Samajwadi Party as an anti-Bharatiya Janata Party secular coalition but the coalition failed in garnering any widespread support, and the party won only 7 seats in 1999 national elections.

In UPA

In the October 1999 elections, RJD fought the election in alliance with Indian National Congress but lost 10 Lok Sabha seats including the seat of Lalu Prasad Yadav.

Rashtriya Janata Dal



Abbreviation	RJD
President	<u>Lalu Prasad Yadav</u>
Chairman	<u>Tejashwi Yadav</u>
Rajya Sabha Leader	<u>Prem Chand Gupta</u>
Lok Sabha Leader	<u>Abhay Kushwaha</u>
Founder	<u>Lalu Prasad Yadav</u> <u>Raghuvansh Prasad Singh</u> <u>Jagada Nand Singh</u> <u>Tulsidas Mehta</u> <u>Abdul Bari Siddiqui</u> <u>Mohammad Shahabuddin</u> <u>Mohammed Taslimuddin</u> <u>Mohammad Ali Ashraf Fatmi</u>
Founded	5 July 1997
Split from	<u>Janata Dal</u>
Headquarters	13, V. P. House, Rafi Marg, <u>New Delhi</u> , <u>India</u> -110001
Student wing	<u>Chhatra Rashtriya Janata Dal</u>
Youth wing	<u>Yuva Rashtriya Janata Dal</u>
Women's wing	<u>Mahila Rashtriya Janata Dal</u>
Ideology	<u>Democratic socialism</u> ^{[1][2]} <u>Left-wing populism</u> ^[3]
Political position	<u>Centre-left</u> ^{[4][1]}
Colours	 Green
Slogan	"Samaj Ka Bal, Rashtriya Janata Dal" "Bihar Ka Vishwas, Lalten Ka Prakash"
ECI Status	State party in Bihar

In the 2000 Bihar election, however, it performed well, winning most of the seats in the state assembly. It gained majority by forming post poll alliance with Congress and agreeing for bifurcation of the state. Continuing its upswing in electoral fortunes, the party won 24 Lok Sabha seats in the 2004 elections that it fought in alliance with Indian National Congress. It was a part of Indian National Congress led United Progressive Alliance (UPA) from 2004 - May 2009, wherein Lalu Yadav held the position of the Minister of Railways.

In February 2005 Bihar Legislative Assembly election RJD won only 75 seats and lost the power. In the state elections held later that year – as a result of no party being able to form a government and RJD continued its downward slide winning only 54 seats.

In 2009 Indian general election, the RJD broke its alliance from UPA when seat sharing talks failed. RJD formed its alliance with Ram Vilas Paswan's Lok Janshakti Party and Mulayam Singh Yadav's Samajwadi Party what the media has dubbed the "Fourth Front". RJD performed poorly and won just four seats, all of them in Bihar. However, in 2010 Assembly election, the RJD did not continue their alliance with Samajwadi Party.

In the 2014 Indian general election, RJD came back to UPA and contested election in alliance with Indian National Congress and Nationalist Congress Party in Bihar. Out of 40 seats in Bihar, RJD will contest on 27 seats, INC on 12 and NCP on one. RJD won only four out of total forty Loksabha seats in Bihar.^{[12][13][14][15][16]}

Organisation

The party leadership consists of the following bodies.

National President

Lalu Prasad Yadav is the National President of RJD.

National Vice President

The national vice president members of the party Mangani Lal Mandal, Mohammad Ilyas Hussain, Ahmed Ashfaq Karim, Rabri Devi, Raghuvansh Prasad Singh, Shivanand Tiwary and Mehboob Ali Kaiser

National Secretary general: Abdul Bari Siddiqui.

National Treasurer: Sunil Kumar Singh^[17]

Political Affairs Committee

National Executive Committee

The national executive members of the party Lalu Prasad Yadav, Tejashwi Yadav, Tej Pratap Yadav, Misa Bharti, Prem Chandra Gupta, Manoj Jha, Abdul Bari Siddiqui and Ram Chandra Purve.^[18]

Alliance

- **National Alliance**
INDIA (since 2023)
- **Regional Alliances**
- MGB (Bihar) (2015–present)
- MGB (Jharkhand) (2019–present)
- LDF (Kerala) (2023-present)
- ASOM (Assam) (2021-present)

Former Alliances

- UPA (2004–2009), (2014-2023)(till dissolved) (National)
- **RJD-LJP Alliance** (2009-2014)
- Congress Alliance (1999-2004)
- Fourth Front (2009)
- Left Front (West Bengal) (2006-2011)
- Mahajot (West Bengal) (2016)
- Mahajot (Assam) (Assam) (2016-2021)
- AIUDF-led Alliance (Assam) (2016)

Seats in Rajya Sabha 5 / 245



Seats in Lok Sabha 4 / 543



Seats in Bihar Legislative Council 14 / 75



Seats in State Legislative Assemblies

List
Bihar Legislative Assembly
25 / 243



Jharkhand Legislative Assembly
4 / 81



Kerala Legislative Assembly
1 / 140



Number of states and union territories in government 2 / 31



Election symbol

The Mahagathbandhan (Grand Alliance) in Bihar

On 14 April 2015, the RJD, Janata Dal (United), Janata Dal (Secular), the Indian National Lok Dal, Samajwadi Party, and Samajwadi Janata Party (Rashtriya) announced that they would merge into a new national Janata Parivar alliance in order to oppose the BJP, thus breaking their long time alliance with the INC.^[19] This would give the alliance 14 Lok Sabha seats and 30 Rajya Sabha seats.

On 7 May 2015, the RJD expelled Pappu Yadav for six years due to anti-RJD activities after speculation rose that he may join the Biju Janata Dal for the 2015 Bihar Legislative Assembly election but he formed a new party called Jan Adhikar Party.^[20]

In November 2015, RJD won the elections as party became the single largest party with 80 followed by Janata Dal (United) with 71 seats, BJP with 53 seats and Congress with 27 seats. In terms of vote share, BJP came first with 24.4%, followed by RJD with 18.4% and JD (U) with 16.8% and Congress got 6.7%. Janata Dal (United)'s Nitish Kumar became the Chief Minister and Lalu's son Tejashwi Yadav became the Deputy Chief Minister of Bihar.

In July 2017, following the corruption cases against Tejashwi Yadav, Nitish Kumar asked Yadav to resign from the cabinet, which was refused by RJD. In order to protect his clean image towards corruption, Nitish Kumar resigned on 26 July 2017, ending RJD's stake in Bihar government. What followed next was a coalition BJP and JDU as a result Nitish Kumar became the Chief Minister again whereas Sushil Modi, a prominent BJP leader became the Deputy Chief Minister.^{[21][22][23]}

Alliance between Indian National Congress and the RJD factioned in October 2021,^{[24][25]} when Tejashwi Yadav gave tickets to candidates in Bihar By-elections,^[26] where Congress was fixed to stand candidates.^{[27][28]}

In August 2022, the Mahagathbandhan, Janata Dal (United), Indian National Congress, Hindustan Awam Morcha and Left Front joined again to form 2/3rd Majority government in Bihar Legislative Assembly.^[29]

In January 2024, Nitish Kumar left the Mahagathbandhan once again and joined hands with the BJP. He later became the chief minister once again.

Controversies and criticism

Mohammad Shahabuddin, a leader of RJD, has been involved in several criminal cases. Shahabuddin has been accused of several murders, be it of political rivals, or police officers.^[30] Shahabuddin, through his lawyers, attempted to also intimidate the legal proceedings, which led to more criminal cases against him.^[31]

During Lalu Prasad Yadav's tenure as Chief Minister, Bihar's law and order was at lowest,^{[32][33]} kidnapping was on rise and private armies mushroomed.^[34] He was also criticized by opposition in the Shilpi-Gautam Murder case and the death of his daughter Ragini Yadav's friend, Abhishek Mishra, in mysterious circumstances.^{[35][36]}

An investigation into the land-for-jobs scam has implicated Lalu Prasad, along with both of his sons, as well as his wife Rabri Devi and his daughter, in addition to their involvement in other corruption scandals.^[37] Tejashwi Yadav allegedly threatened Central Bureau of Investigation agents who were investigating him in another corruption case.^[38]



Party flag



Website

rjd.co.in (<https://rjd.co.in/>)

[Politics of India](#) · [Political parties](#) · [Elections](#)



RJD Women's wing office in Delhi

Electoral performance

Lok Sabha elections

Lok Sabha Term	Indian General election	Seats contested	Seats won	Votes Polled	% of votes	State (seats)	Ref.
13th Lok Sabha	1999	61	7 / 543	10,150,492	2.79	Bihar (7)	[39]
14th Lok Sabha	2004	42	24 / 543	9,384,147	2.4	Bihar (22) Jharkhand (2)	[39]
15th Lok Sabha	2009	44	4 / 543	5,280,084	1.3	Bihar (4)	[39]
16th Lok Sabha	2014	30	4 / 543	7,442,313	1.4	Bihar (4)	[39]
17th Lok Sabha	2019	21	0 / 543	6,631,585	1.1	N/A	[39]
18th Lok Sabha	2024	23	4 / 543	10,107,402	1.57	Bihar (4)	[40]

Bihar Vidhan Sabha (Lower House) Election

Vidhan Sabha Term	Assembly Elections	Seats Contested	Seats Won	% of votes	% of votes in seats contested	Party Votes	Ref
12th Vidhan Sabha	2000	293	124 / 324	28.34	31.28	10,500,361	[41]
13th Vidhan Sabha	2005 February	210	71 / 243	25.07	28.35	6,140,223	[42]
14th Vidhan Sabha	2005 October	175	54 / 243	23.45	32.63	5,525,081	[43]
15th Vidhan Sabha	2010	168	22 / 243	18.84	27.31	5,475,656	[44]
16th Vidhan Sabha	2015	101	80 / 243	18.4	44.35	6,995,509	[45]
17th Vidhan Sabha	2020	144	75 / 243	23.11	38.96	9,738,855	[46]
18th Vidhan Sabha	2025	143	0 / 243				

Jharkhand Vidhan Sabha Election

Vidhan Sabha Term	Jharkhand Assembly Elections	Seats Contested	Seats Won	% of votes	Party Votes	Ref
2nd Vidhan Sabha	<u>2005</u>	51	7 / 81	8.48		[47]
3rd Vidhan Sabha	<u>2009</u>	56	5 / 81	5.03	517,324	[48]
4th Vidhan Sabha	<u>2014</u>	19	0 / 81	3.13	133,815	[49]
5th Vidhan Sabha	<u>2019</u>	7	1 / 81	2.75	413,167	[50]
6th Vidhan Sabha	<u>2024</u>	7	4 / 81	3.44	613,880	[51]

List of chief ministers

Chief ministers

No.	Name	Term in office			Party	Assembly (Election)
1	Lalu Prasad Yadav	10 March 1990	28 March 1995	5 years, 18 days	Janata Dal	Tenth Assembly
2	Lalu Prasad Yadav	4 April 1995	25 July 1997	2 years, 112 days	Janata Dal	Eleventh Assembly
3	Rabri Devi	25 July 1997	11 February 1999	1 year, 201 days	Rashtriya Janata Dal	Eleventh Assembly
4	Rabri Devi	9 March 1999	2 March 2000	359 days	Rashtriya Janata Dal	Eleventh Assembly
5	Rabri Devi	11 March 2000	6 March 2005	4 years, 360 days	Rashtriya Janata Dal	Twelfth Assembly

Deputy chief ministers

No.	Name	Term in office			Assembly (Election)
1.	Tejashwi Yadav	26 November 2015	26 July 2017	1 year, 244 days	17th Bihar Assembly
2.	Tejashwi Yadav	10 August 2022	28 January 2024	1 year, 171 days	18th Bihar Assembly

List of central ministers

No.	Photo	Portfolio	Name (Birth–Death)	Assumed office	Left office	Duration	Constituency (House)		Manmohan Singh
1		<u>Minister of Railways</u>	<u>Lalu Prasad Yadav</u> (born 1948)	23 May 2004	22 May 2009	4 years, 364 days	Chapra (Lok Sabha)		
2		<u>Minister of Company Affairs [MoS(I/C)]</u>	<u>Prem Chand Gupta</u> (born 1950)	23 May 2004	29 Jan 2006	1 year, 251 days	Bihar (Rajya Sabha)		
		<u>Minister of Company Affairs</u>		29 Jan 2006	9 May 2007	1 year, 100 days			
		<u>Minister of Corporate Affairs</u>		9 May 2007	22 May 2009	2 years, 13 days			
3		<u>Minister of Rural Development</u>	<u>Raghuvansh Prasad Singh</u> (1946–2020)				Vaishali (Lok Sabha)		
4		<u>Minister of Agriculture (MoS)</u>	<u>Akhilesh Prasad Singh</u> (born 1962)	23 May 2004	22 May 2009	4 years, 364 days	Motihari (Lok Sabha)		
		<u>Minister of Food and Civil Supplies, Consumer Affairs & Public Distribution (MoS)</u>							
5		<u>Minister of Water Resources (MoS)</u>	<u>Jay Prakash Narayan Yadav</u> (born 1954)	23 May 2004	6 Nov 2005	1 year, 167 days	Monghyr (Lok Sabha)		
				24 Oct 2006	22 May 2009	2 years, 210 days			
6		<u>Minister of Heavy Industries & Public Enterprises (MoS)</u>	<u>Kanti Singh</u> (born 1957)	29 Jan 2006	6 Apr 2008	2 years, 68 days	Arrah (Lok Sabha)		
		<u>Minister of Human Resource Development (MoS)</u>		23 May 2004	29 Jan 2006	1 year, 251 days			
		<u>Minister of Tourism (MoS)</u>		6 Apr 2008	22 May 2009	1 year, 46 days			
		<u>Minister of Culture (MoS)</u>							
7		<u>Minister of Human</u>	<u>Mohammad Ali Ashraf</u>	23 May 2004	22 May	4 years, 364 days	Darbhanga (Lok Sabha)		

		Resource Development (MoS)	Fatmi (born 1956)		2009				
8		Minister of Heavy Industries & Public Enterprises (MoS)	Mohammed Taslimuddin (1943–2017)	23 May 2004	25 May 2004	2 days	Kishanganj (Lok Sabha)		
		Minister of Agriculture (MoS)							
		Minister of Food and Civil Supplies, Consumer Affairs & Public Distribution (MoS)		25 May 2004	22 May 2009	4 years, 362 days			

Prominent members

Present members

- Md Ali Ashraf Fatmi, close aide of Lalu Prasad Yadav, RJD Co-founder and ex- Union Minister for Human Resource Development, Four time member of parliament.
- Abdul Bari Siddiqui, close associate of Lalu Prasad Yadav former Leader of Leader of Opposition following the 2010 Bihar Legislative Assembly election until the split between JD(U) and BJP and former Finance Minister Govt. of Bihar. Former Bihar RJD President.
- Alok Kumar Mehta, National General Secretary of Rashtriya Janata Dal.^[52]
- Prem Kumar Mani, Vice President and Strategist of RJD.
- Jagada Nand Singh, Former State President of RJD for Bihar.^[53]
- Shivchandra Ram, former Member of legislative Assembly.^[54]
- Ram Chandra Purve is a Former member of the Bihar Legislative Council. Former state president of RJD.
- Jay Prakash Narayan Yadav General Secretary, RJD. Former Cabinet Minister Bihar Govt. Former Union Minister, MP.
- Sarfaraz Alam Former Minister Bihar Govt. Former MP Araria.
- Manoj Jha MP Rajya Sabha and National Spokesperson of RJD.
- Prem Chand Gupta MP Rajya Sabha and former cabinet minister in Ministry of Company Affairs of India in First Manmohan Singh ministry.
- Ahmad Ashfaq Karim Former MP Rajya Sabha.
- Surendra Prasad Yadav senior RJD leader and Member of Bihar Legislative Assembly from Belaganj. Chairman of the Public Accounts Committee.
- K. P. Mohanan, Party head Kerala Legislative Assembly.^[55]

Late members

- Raghuvansh Prasad Singh, close aide of Lalu Prasad Yadav, RJD Co-founder and Union Minister for Rural Development.
- Raghunath Jha, close aide of Lalu Prasad Yadav, RJD Co-founder and Union Minister. Responsible for start of Lalu Raj in Bihar.
- Mohammad Shahabuddin He was a former Member of Parliament from the Siwan constituency in the state of Bihar,^[56] former National Vice President and a former member of the National Executive Committee of the RJD, close associate of Lalu Prasad Yadav.

List of State Presidents of Bihar

No.	Name	Term Start	Term End
1.	<u>Abdul Bari Siddiqui</u>	1997	2010
2.	<u>Ram Chandra Purve</u>	2010	2019
3.	<u>Jagada Nand Singh</u>	2019	2025
4.	<u>Mangani Lal Mandal</u>	2025	Incumbent

See also

- Tejashwi Yadav
- Lalu Prasad Yadav
- List of political parties in India

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